

Finder Site Notes V1.2 — Status

Ben Caudwell's notes (06/07/2026), checked against the live jdmfinder.com.au codebase. Reviewed 13 July 2026. Test suite passing, 333 of 333.

24

DONE

4

PARTLY DONE

10

NOT STARTED

Login page

p2

- ✓ Get rid of "admins can leave this blank"

Placeholder is now just `you@email.com`.

- ✓ Make "New here?" link more intuitive and visible

Now reads "New here? Sign up to start searching", bold and underlined. Your wording.

Search page

p3

- ✓ Popular search tiles: remove them or finish them

The broken image tiles are gone. Text-only now.

- ✓ Replace the made-up stats, or show nothing

500+ / 15+ / 100,000+ are gone. Replaced with true numbers: 40,000 listings scanned daily, 3 auction houses in one feed, 100% of landed cost shown up front.

- ✗ A way to tell models apart (Mercedes, BMW, Toyota Crown)

Not started. This is the same problem as the section below.

Model code and grade — your "best idea"

p4

- ✗ Let the user select the chassis number / model code

- ✗ Model code, then a dropdown of the possible grades (the AUCRS pattern)

- ✗ Friendly model code labels, e.g. "222058 – S450"

- ✗ Flow: make → model → model code → available grades

- ✗ Allow multiple grades to be selected at once

- ✓ "Is the make list generated by Claude or from the API?"

From the auction feed, live. Not a hand-written list. Whatever the auction houses list is what you see.

- ✓ The Mercedes AMG / E55 problem

Already handled. The matcher does a best-match on Make that catches both MERCEDES BENZ and MERCEDES AMG. This was your own fallback suggestion on p15, and it is live.

Request wizard

p5

- ✓ "Recent examples imported" tiles don't work
Now driven by real sold-lot data, and they hide themselves when there is nothing to show.
- ✓ "Delivering to (country, if outside Australia)" reads awkward
Replaced with a single field labelled "Country", prefilled with Australia. Exactly as you asked.
- ✓ "Refine my search" belongs on the Find car page
Moved.

Passwords and login

p6–p7

- ✓ Password "set" links are broken
Fixed. The three account types were tripping over each other during lookup.
- ✓ Need a way to reset people's passwords
"Forgot password?" added to the login page, plus a "Send password reset" button on customer, agent and dealer records in admin.
- ✓ "Login doesn't work, signup does"
Fixed. Signup and login were scrambling passwords differently. There is now an automated test using your exact bengc2000@gmail.com case so it cannot come back.
- ✗ "Why buyers use JDM Connect" card — make this better
Left alone, waiting on your direction. You said you'd think of how later.

Buyer portal

p8

- ≈ "Show more useful information here" (the Lot 6ryZINDpTKc2DI rows)
Partly done. Cards now show year, make, model, a photo, the auction house, close date and the landed estimate. Still missing: the match-strength chip (it is already calculated, just not shown), sent/viewed/expired status, and the card does not click through to the match.

V1.1 items

p9–p12

- ✓ Remove the agent/client references and the admin login instructions
- ✓ Add a timeout for login requests, server side
1.5 second delay on every failed attempt. Account locks for 15 minutes after 10 failures.
- ✓ Character limit on the email and password fields
- ✓ Force a stricter password policy
Minimum is now 10 characters, not 6.
- ✓ Pasting sometimes doesn't work
Nothing in the code blocks pasting. Should be reliable now.
- ✓ Cap password length at about 32 characters

- ✓ Limit the allowed symbols, tooltip rather than always visible
Done exactly as specified, including your symbol list.
- ✓ Force people to create an account
Password is now a required field, and the "no signup required" copy is gone.
- ✓ Changing the Make clears the selected Model
- ✓ Stop free typing in the Model field, and drop the "pick or type" hint
It is a proper dropdown now, select-only.
- ✓ Fix having to backspace before you can reopen the Model list
Gone, along with the free-text field.
- ✓ Put the nickname at the top of "What you're looking for"
- ✓ Change "Choose a preset" to "No preset"
- ✓ Budget in yen means nothing to customers
Field is now "Max budget (AUD, on-road)" with the yen equivalent shown live underneath, worked out from a stripped-back version of the real landed cost calculator. Exactly what you proposed.
- ✓ Chassis code isn't clearing when you pick a new preset
Fixed.
- ✓ "I had a stroke trying to read this"
Fixed. The sticky bars were see-through enough that the page text bled through them as you scrolled.
- ≈ Presets need work, a lot aren't eligible
All presets have been removed for now, on a "ship empty rather than wrong" basis. You offered to spend an hour building the correct list. That is the unblock, and it's on you.

General changes, site wide

p12–p13

- ≈ Character limits on all fields
Done on the public request form. The admin forms still have none at all (Add agent, Add customer, Edit customer).
- ≈ Validation on all fields, e.g. Year 1970 to 2050
The public form is right. The admin and portal wishlist forms do no checking at all, so nonsense or negative years go straight into the database.
- ✗ WhatsApp number validation
Still just "8 or more digits". No real format check.
- ✗ Check if an email has already been used, without leaking anything
Not done, and currently doing the opposite. The site says "That email already has an account. Sign in instead.", which tells anyone who asks whether a given email is one of our customers. Worth fixing, and it's a small change.

Issues / Fixes — the ones you flagged twice

p13

- ✓ Character limit on the username and password fields
You marked this "same as V1, not fixed". It is fixed now.

- ✓ Login attempt timeout and account logout
1 to 2 second delay between attempts, locks after 10 failures. Built to your spec.

Wishlists / saved searches

p14–p15

- ✗ Search by trim / variant / grade
Not done. Same job as the model code work above.
- ✗ Make it a searchable list, like the IMD Eligibility Make search
Not done. Make is still a plain dropdown.
- ✓ Your alternative: leave it and do a "best match" search
Done, and it handles your E55 example.
- ✗ Add a "Model Code" field
- ✗ Wishlist size limit — "we can accidentally DDOS ourselves"
Not done. You can no longer save a search with no criteria at all, but there is still no cap on how many wishlists one customer can create.
- ✗ Filter matching: fuzzy filter or dropdown, AUCRS style
Not done as a UI. The matcher does already do a loose contains-match on grade behind the scenes.
- ≈ Preset dropdown per model
The mechanism is built. The list is empty, waiting on your sign-off.

Parked — ideas, not asks

p14–p16

- ✗ Daily rare-car finder feeding Facebook and Instagram stories
Your words: "cool idea, not yet".
- ✗ Tiers of service (\$10 / \$50 / \$499 / \$1200)
You noted the prices are arbitrary. Needs a business decision before any code.
- ✗ Saved-search capture for leads who aren't ready to pay

⚠ One thing that isn't on your list

The admin password is printed in plain text on page 1 of your document, and admin login still works by leaving the email blank and typing it in. That PDF has been emailed around. Rotating it takes two minutes and is the highest-value thing on this page.

Suggested order from here

1. Rotate the admin password.
2. Close the "that email already has an account" leak. Small change, and it is the opposite of what you asked for.
3. Ben supplies the vetted preset list. One hour, and it unblocks a dropdown that currently ships empty.
4. Put limits and validation on the admin forms, and cap wishlists per customer.
5. Then model code and grade search. This is the real product work and deserves its own planning session, since Ben has strong opinions on how AUCRS does it.

✓ done ≈ partly done ✗ not started